# Architecture, art and design

1. Read the article once for meaning. 2. Read it again and look at the **highlighted new words** and the **blue phrases** in context. 3. Study the tables. 4. Use at least 5 new words in speaking or writing this week.

## Article: Art, buildings and the beauty of design (170 words)

Great buildings are works of art as well as shelters. A skilled **architect** chooses the **facade** and the shape of a **dome** or **column** with care, and a famous **landmark** can become a symbol of a whole city. A **Gothic** cathedral, with its tall windows, shows how medieval builders pushed the limits of stone. Many old buildings are **in need of repair**, so experts **restore** or **renovate** them to protect the national **monument** heritage.

Art follows similar traditions. A painter may work on a large **canvas** to produce a **portrait**, while a sculptor shapes metal or stone into a **sculpture**. A museum **curator** selects pieces for an **exhibition** in a public **gallery**, and visitors often admire a true **masterpiece** for hours. Some artists prefer an **abstract** style that avoids realistic shapes, others a patient **craft** such as **pottery**.

Good design is more than decoration: an **aesthetic** judgment guides every choice. As new styles **catch on**, designers must find ways of **blending in** with the past while giving each project a fresh identity.

## Useful phrases from the article

| PHRASE | MEANING |
|---|---|
| **in need of repair** | damaged |
| **catch on** | become popular |
| **blending in** | fitting well |

## The 20 new words

| WORD | | MEANING | EXAMPLE |
|---|---|---|---|
| **architect** | n | a person who designs buildings | *The architect won an award.* |
| **facade** | n | the front of a building | *The facade was covered in glass.* |
| **landmark** | n | a famous building or place | *The tower is a city landmark.* |
| **sculpture** | n | a work of art in stone or metal | *The sculpture stands in the square.* |
| **portrait** | n | a picture of a person | *The portrait shows the queen.* |
| **exhibition** | n | a public show of art | *The exhibition opened in May.* |
| **masterpiece** | n | an outstanding work of art | *The painting is a masterpiece.* |
| **abstract** | adj | not showing real objects | *Abstract art uses shapes and colors.* |

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| **renovate** | v | to repair and improve a building | *They renovated the old theater.* |
| **restore** | v | to bring back to its original state | *Experts restored the fresco.* |
| **Gothic** | adj | a style of medieval architecture | *The Gothic cathedral has tall windows.* |
| **column** | n | a tall vertical post supporting a building | *Marble columns line the hall.* |
| **dome** | n | a round roof | *The dome is visible from far away.* |
| **canvas** | n | cloth for painting | *He painted on a large canvas.* |
| **curator** | n | a person who looks after a museum collection | *The curator chose forty paintings.* |
| **gallery** | n | a place where art is shown | *The gallery is open daily.* |
| **craft** | n | skill in making things by hand | *Traditional crafts are disappearing.* |
| **pottery** | n | objects made from baked clay | *Ancient pottery was found at the site.* |
| **aesthetic** | adj | connected with beauty | *The design has great aesthetic value.* |
| **monument** | n | a structure built to remember something | *The monument honors the soldiers.* |

## Revision: 10 words from last week

| WORD | | MEANING |
|---|---|---|
| **entrepreneur** | n | a person who starts new businesses |
| **startup** | n | a new small business |
| **revenue** | n | the money a company receives |
| **market share** | n | the part of sales a company controls |
| **customer loyalty** | n | customers who keep buying from you |
| **competitor** | n | a rival company |
| **merger** | n | the joining of two companies |
| **supply chain** | n | the steps from making to selling goods |
| **demand** | n | the wish of buyers to purchase |
| **supply** | n | the amount of goods available |

## Practice: fill the gaps

canvas · Gothic · curator · sculpture · craft · masterpiece · abstract · architect

1. He painted on a large _____.
2. The _____ cathedral has tall windows.
3. The _____ chose forty paintings.

4. The _____ stands in the square.
5. Traditional _____ are disappearing.
6. The painting is a _____.
7. _____ art uses shapes and colors.
8. The _____ won an award.

## More words on this topic (not in the article: choose the 10 most useful for you)

**ancient monument** (n): an old structure of national importance
**arch** (n): a curved structure over an opening
**avant-garde** (adj): very new and experimental
**baroque** (adj): a rich, decorative style
**brushstroke** (n): a mark made by a brush
**bust** (n): a sculpture of a head and shoulders
**ceiling** (n): the top of a room
**chapel** (n): a small church
**collage** (n): a picture made of pasted pieces
**contemporary** (adj): of the present time
**cubism** (n): a style using geometric shapes
**decorative** (adj): used to make things look nice
**drawing** (n): a picture made with a pencil
**engraving** (n): a picture cut into metal
**fresco** (n): a painting on a wall
**heritage** (n): the culture inherited from the past
**impressionism** (n): a style that captures light
**installation** (n): an art work set in a space
**landscape** (n): a painting of countryside
**mosaic** (n): a picture made from small pieces
**mural** (n): a large wall painting
**oil painting** (n): a painting made with oil paint
**palace** (n): a large, grand home of a ruler
**sketch** (n): a quick drawing
**spire** (n): a tall pointed tower
**stained glass** (n): colored glass in a window
**still life** (n): a painting of objects
**studio** (n): an artist's workroom
**tapestry** (n): a woven picture
**watercolor** (n): a painting made with water paint

## Answers

1. canvas (canvas)
2. Gothic (Gothic)
3. curator (curator)
4. sculpture (sculpture)
5. crafts (craft)
6. masterpiece (masterpiece)
7. Abstract (abstract)
8. architect (architect)